

A CHASE THROUGH A TRAP RIDDLED SWAMP

Our heroes pursue a villain fleeing through a flooded woodland. Their success in this montage determines whether they catch up to the villain at its end, or if the villain escapes without a trace.

You can use one of the following hooks for this encounter, replacing any of the named concepts with elements from your own campaign:

Lizardfolk Bandits on the Run. Red Theon, a lizardfolk deathrex and his mercenary band, fled into the East Saffron Slough after stealing a sapphire crown. If he gets away, Red Theon hopes to use the crown to access an ancient temple and enlist a massive undead army into his ranks.

The Boy and the Beast. A young boy was kidnapped by the Bogwolf, a werewolf who preyed upon the local village for years. The Bogwolf and his coterie of swamp minions will do anything to keep his estranged son.

The Most Dangerous Game. The legendary draconian bounty hunter Zevyylax races the heroes across the Darklakes to capture a fleeing goblin cartographer. The goblin refuses to let her work fall into enemy hands!

Moderate Montage Test

The heroes will need to contend with the swamp's natural defenses and swamp gas magic. The terrain is also laden with old hunting traps that'll punish their failures. Not only that, the villain's reinforcements (or a third party) will be closing in on them rapidly.

If the heroes succeed, they'll catch up to the villain just before leaving the woodlands. Otherwise, the villain escapes long before the heroes do, and the heroes need to determine where they went.

Swamp Chase Test Difficulty

Heroes	Success Limit	Failure Limit
3	4	2
4	5	2
5	6	3
6	7	4

Encounter Credits

Designer: Willy Abeel

Editor: Graeme Bloodworth

Playtest Coordinators: Gina Devlin, Bennoni Thomas, Riley Forge

Playtest Contributors: Jonas Tintenseher, Alden Parker, Aidan Mazagonwalla, Vin "Oatmeal" Delstock, Lilian Bonjean, Connel Bjorkstrand, Jake Levy, Joe Keller

Lizardfolk Deathrex Art: Michael Cookie Niewiadomy

Setting the Scene

- "The schlomp, schlomp, schlomp of heavy steps in the muck quickly fade away beneath the drone of insects and gentle sloshing of water. Discarded rope and shovels dot the dark landscape."
- "A thick fog hangs above deep waters, doing well to conceal the few strips of land ahead. Alligators and swinging vines drift in and out of view."
- "Orbs of light float between the trees, causing the area around them to shift and change. The path through the bog suddenly morphs without warning."

Montage Test Challenges

The following challenges are all suitable for the montage test. While the traps are still active, a hero that incurs a consequence on a test causes the next hero to fall victim to a trap and take a bane on their next test unless they spend a recovery:

Track the Villain: The heroes can search for tracks and keep on the villain's tail.

Special: This challenge can be completed twice.

Suggested Characteristics: Reason, Intuition.

Suggested Skills: Climb, Search, Track.

Navigate the Foggy Waters: The water is treacherous and filled with leeches and deep pits, while the thick fog above it obscures the way ahead.

Suggested Characteristics: Might, Agility, Reason.

Suggested Skills: Alertness, Endurance, Navigate, Swim.

Ward off Hungry Fauna: Gators and massive bugs looking for a meal will close in unless they're scared off.

Suggested Characteristics: Reason, Presence.

Suggested Skills: Handle Animals, Intimidate, Perform.

Find the Traps: Thin tripwire hides in the fog while mud and dead leaves cover bear traps and snares.

Suggested Characteristics: Reason, Intuition.

Suggested Skills: Alertness, Search, Nature.

Disarm Traps: The heroes can carefully clear the trap triggers to make their trek less treacherous.

Special: Tests made to disarm traps take a bane until the find the traps challenge is completed.

Suggested Characteristics: Agility, Reason.

Suggested Skills: Escape Artist, Mechanics, Sabotage.

Extinguish swamp wisps: Rot motes create illusions in the fog and threaten to lead victims in circles.

Suggested Characteristics: Might, Reason, Presence.

Suggested Skills: Endurance, Intimidate, Magic, Nature.

Starting from Round 2, enemy reinforcements move in to interfere with the heroes.

- ♦ “They’ve been here!” echoes over the water. Splashing and footsteps grow louder and louder behind.”
- ♦ “Shadows soar overhead. Suddenly, ringed darts dot the length of a nearby tree.”

Add the following challenges. The heroes take a bane on all tests until either of these challenges are completed:

Throw them off the Trail: The heroes can hide in the slough or create distractions while they continue their pursuit.

Suggested Characteristic: Reason, Intuition.

Suggested Skills: Disguise, Hide, Sneak, Track.

Repel the Reinforcements: Enemies (such as lizardfolk skyterrors) glide through the trees firing poison darts.

Suggested Characteristics: Might, Agility, Presence.

Suggested Skills: Endurance, Intimidate, Jump, Strategy.

Montage Test Outcomes

The montage test has the following outcomes:

Total Success: The heroes caught up to the villain quickly! They earn 2 Victories each.

Partial Success: The heroes make it out of the swamp a little after the villain did. They aren’t too far behind! They earn 1 Victory each.

Total Failure: The heroes lose track of the villain. They scramble out of the bog but lose half their recoveries.

Rewards

The heroes can earn the following reward:

Title: Bog Buster

The way out is through.

Prerequisites: Earn a total success on the encounter.

Effect: Choose one of the following benefits:

Bog Haunt: While you are in a swamp, not surprised, and sufficient cover can be found in the starting area, you can attempt to hide at the start of combat (no action required).

Nature Step: You can shift into difficult terrain.

Swamp Angel: You gain an edge on tests made to track creatures and objects through swamps and woodlands.

